



SPONSOR: Rep. Griffith & Sen. Poore
Reps. Berry, Burns, K. Johnson, Minor-Brown, Neal,
Osienski, Yearick; Sens. Hansen, Hocker, Hoffner,
Huxtable, Mantzavinos, Pinkney, Sokola, Wilson

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
153rd GENERAL ASSEMBLY

HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 93

DESIGNATING FEBRUARY 28, 2026, AS "RARE DISEASE DAY" IN THE STATE OF DELAWARE.

1 WHEREAS, there are nearly 7,000 diseases and conditions considered rare, each affecting fewer than 200,000
2 Americans, and only about 500 have approved treatments in the United States, according to the National Institutes of
3 Health; and

4 WHEREAS, while each of these diseases may affect small numbers of people, rare diseases as a group affect
5 almost 30 million Americans; and

6 WHEREAS, many rare diseases are serious and debilitating conditions that have a significant impact on the lives
7 of those affected; and

8 WHEREAS, while more than 450 drugs and biologics have been approved for the treatment of rare diseases
9 according to the Food and Drug Administration, millions of Americans still have rare diseases for which there is no
10 approved treatment; and

11 WHEREAS, individuals and families affected by rare diseases often experience problems such as diagnosis delay,
12 difficulty finding a medical expert, and lack of access to treatments or ancillary services; and

13 WHEREAS, the public is familiar with some rare diseases and may be sympathetic to those affected, many
14 patients and families affected by less widely-known rare diseases bear a large share of the burden of funding research and
15 raising public awareness to support the search for treatments; and

16 WHEREAS, one example of a rare disease is Lissencephaly, a condition that is characterized by agyria or
17 pachygyria, which means absence or incomplete development, respectively, of the brain gyri or convolution, causing the
18 brain's surface to appear unusually smooth with an estimated less than 1,000 individuals diagnosed worldwide and many
19 others undiagnosed; and

20 WHEREAS, another example of a rare disease is Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome or "EDS", a group of inherited
21 disorders that affect connective tissues, primarily the skin, joints, and blood vessel walls, and may be closely linked to
22 gastroparesis, a condition in which the stomach muscles don't move food as they should for it to be properly digested; and

23 WHEREAS, thousands of Delaware residents are among those affected by rare diseases since nearly 1 in 10
24 Americans have rare diseases; and

25 WHEREAS, in July 2023, Delaware became the 27th state to establish a Rare Disease Advisory Council through
26 the passage of SB 55 to raise awareness and create a platform to educate the public, state agencies, and the General
27 Assembly about rare diseases and to make policy recommendations that improve patient access to critical health care
28 services; and

29 WHEREAS, there are now a total of 30 states across the country that have established a Rare Disease Advisory
30 Council as of June 2025; and

31 WHEREAS, the National Organization for Rare Disorders organized a nationwide observance of “Rare Disease
32 Day” on February 29, 2024, to provide an energy and focal point that enables rare diseases advocacy work to progress on
33 the local, national, and international levels; and

34 WHEREAS, thousands of patients and caregivers, medical professionals, researchers, companies developing
35 orphan products to treat people with rare diseases, and others in the State of Delaware will participate in that observance.

36 NOW, THEREFORE:

37 BE IT RESOLVED by the House of Representatives of the 153rd General Assembly of the State of Delaware, the
38 Senate concurring therein, that February 28, 2026, is recognized as “Rare Disease Day” in the State of Delaware.

SYNOPSIS

This House Concurrent Resolution recognizes February 28, 2026, as "Rare Disease Day" in Delaware.